

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

NovaSphere Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

Policies, Benefits, Leave & Workplace Standards

India | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 April 2026

Fictional company details are used throughout this document. The policy principles are written for an Indian private-sector employer and should be reviewed by qualified HR/legal professionals before adoption.

Document Control & Important Notice

Item	Details
Company	NovaSphere Technologies Pvt. Ltd. (fictional)
Registered office	5th Floor, Meridian Business Park, Hyderabad, Telangana – 500081 (dummy)
Policy owner	People & Culture
Version	1.0
Effective date	01 April 2026
Review cycle	At least annually, or sooner if law/business needs change
Applicability	Employees of NovaSphere Technologies Pvt. Ltd. in India, subject to role, location, employment terms and applicable law

This handbook is an internal policy template, not legal advice. Statutory requirements can vary by state, establishment, employee category and circumstance. Where applicable law provides a more favourable entitlement, the law will prevail.

How to Use This Handbook

- Employees should read this handbook together with their appointment letter, employment agreement, benefit documents and applicable local policies.
- Managers are responsible for consistent application and timely escalation of exceptions.
- HR maintains the authoritative version and may issue policy circulars or operating procedures.
- Nothing in this handbook creates a guarantee of employment for any particular period.

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The following pages expand these topics into practical employee-facing rules and procedures.

1. Company Values & Employment Principles

Purpose

NovaSphere aims to create a professional, inclusive and high-performing workplace where employees can do meaningful work, develop their skills and treat customers and colleagues with respect.

Core Values

- Integrity — act honestly, comply with law and keep commitments.
- Customer focus — understand impact and deliver dependable outcomes.
- Ownership — take responsibility for decisions, results and learning.
- Respect — communicate professionally and value differences.
- Collaboration — share information, ask for help and solve problems together.
- Continuous improvement — learn from outcomes and improve systems.

Employment Principles

The company intends to make employment decisions based on legitimate business requirements, performance, capability, conduct and applicable law. Discrimination, harassment, retaliation and abusive conduct are not acceptable.

Policy Hierarchy

If this handbook conflicts with applicable law, the law prevails. If an individual employment contract provides a more favourable lawful benefit, the more favourable provision may apply unless the contract states otherwise.

2. Employment Categories & Working Arrangements

Category	Typical meaning
Permanent employee	Employee engaged without a fixed end date, subject to probation/confirmation terms.
Probationer	New employee undergoing an initial assessment period as stated in the appointment letter.
Fixed-term employee	Employee engaged for a defined period or project under written terms.
Intern / trainee	Individual engaged for structured learning or training, under separate terms.
Consultant / contractor	Non-employee service provider governed by a commercial contract.

Probation

The appointment letter will specify probation duration and confirmation requirements. HR may extend probation where permitted by the employment terms and applicable law.

Work Location

Employees may be assigned to an office, client site, approved remote location or hybrid arrangement. Business needs, security requirements and customer commitments may require attendance at a designated location.

Employment Records

Employees must keep personal, bank, tax, emergency-contact and statutory information accurate and promptly report material changes.

3. Working Hours, Attendance & Remote Work

Working Hours

Standard office hours are 9:00 a.m. to 6:00 p.m., Monday through Friday, including a normal meal break. Actual schedules may vary by team, shift, client requirement or applicable law.

Attendance

- Employees should be available during agreed working hours and record attendance/time as required.
- Late arrival or early departure should be communicated to the manager where reasonably foreseeable.
- Overtime or work beyond scheduled hours must be handled according to applicable law and company approval procedures.

Hybrid / Remote Work

- Remote work is a work arrangement, not an entitlement, unless specifically provided by contract or policy.
- Employees must maintain a suitable work environment and protect company information.
- Managers may require office attendance for collaboration, customer meetings, training or business continuity.
- Company devices and systems must be used in accordance with information-security rules.

Right to Disconnect

Employees are encouraged to respect reasonable boundaries outside working hours. Genuine emergencies, critical incidents and role-specific requirements may require contact outside normal hours, subject to applicable law and company practice.

4. Leave & Time-Off Policy

Leave is intended to support rest, health, family responsibilities and personal needs while enabling business continuity. Leave entitlements are administered subject to applicable Indian central/state law and the employee's employment terms.

Illustrative Annual Leave Matrix

Leave type	Illustrative entitlement	Approval / evidence
Earned / Privilege Leave (EL/PL)	18 working days per calendar year	Prior approval; advance notice where practicable
Casual Leave (CL)	7 days per calendar year	Manager approval; short-notice use permitted for genuine needs
Sick Leave (SL)	7 days per calendar year	Notify manager promptly; medical proof may be requested where appropriate
Public / Festival Holidays	As per annual holiday calendar	No leave application normally required
Maternity leave	As provided by applicable law	HR process and supporting documents
Paternity / co-parent leave	5 working days, subject to company policy and applicable law	Normally within the period surrounding childbirth
Bereavement leave	Up to 5 working days for immediate family	Notify manager/HR; reasonable documentation may be requested
Adoption / commissioning parent leave	As applicable under law/company policy	HR approval and supporting documents
Unpaid Leave / LOP	Case-by-case	Prior written approval except emergencies

The above matrix is an illustrative company policy. Statutory entitlements, including maternity and applicable state leave requirements, will always be administered in accordance with prevailing law.

5. Holidays

HR publishes an annual holiday calendar for each applicable work location. The calendar will account for statutory/public holidays and operational requirements.

Holiday category	Illustrative treatment
National / statutory holidays	As applicable to the establishment and location
Festival holidays	Selected through the annual company holiday calendar
Restricted / optional holidays	May be offered subject to annual calendar and manager approval
Working holidays / shifts	May apply to support operations; compensatory treatment will follow applicable law/company rules

Holiday Falling During Leave

Treatment of holidays falling between leave days will follow the applicable leave rules and statutory requirements. Employees should check the leave system or HR for location-specific treatment.

Holiday Calendar Changes

Business continuity, government notifications or local requirements may require calendar adjustments. HR will communicate material changes.

6. Sick Leave & Medical Absence

Notification

An employee who cannot attend work because of illness should notify the manager or designated attendance channel as early as reasonably possible, preferably before the normal start time.

Medical Certificate

For extended absence, repeated medical absence, or where required by law/company procedure, HR may request reasonable medical documentation. The company will handle such information confidentially and only for legitimate purposes.

Fitness to Return

Where a health condition materially affects safe performance of work, the company may request appropriate fitness documentation consistent with law and privacy principles.

Hospitalisation / Serious Illness

Employees or their family members should contact HR for support with leave, insurance, statutory benefits and return-to-work arrangements. The company will consider reasonable accommodations where required by law and practicable.

7. Parental, Adoption & Family Leave

Maternity

Eligible employees will receive maternity benefits in accordance with the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961, as amended, and other applicable law. HR will confirm eligibility, required notice and documentation.

Paternity / Co-parent Leave

NovaSphere provides an illustrative company benefit of 5 working days for eligible employees around the birth of a child, subject to policy rules. This company benefit does not replace any statutory entitlement.

Adoption

Employees adopting a child may receive benefits available under applicable law and company policy. Eligibility and duration will depend on the legal framework applicable to the employee and circumstances.

Family Care

Employees may request annual/casual leave or unpaid leave for significant family-care needs. HR may consider flexible work or other arrangements where business requirements permit.

Return to Work

Managers should support a smooth return, including reasonable transition time, work allocation and legally required facilities/benefits.

8. Bereavement, Compassionate & Special Leave

The company recognises the need for time away from work following significant personal events.

Situation	Illustrative company support
Death of spouse, child, parent or legal guardian	Up to 5 working days bereavement leave
Death of sibling, grandparent or parent-in-law	Up to 3 working days bereavement leave
Critical family emergency	CL/EL/SL or unpaid leave, depending on circumstances
Marriage of employee	Up to 3 working days special leave
Relocation due to company transfer	Reasonable time as approved by HR/manager
Jury/court/government duty	As required by law or approved by HR

Special leave categories may be expanded or adjusted by HR through policy circulars. Employees should not be penalised for making a genuine request for protected statutory leave.

9. Leave Administration & Carry Forward

Leave Year

The standard leave year is 1 January to 31 December unless HR specifies otherwise for a particular statutory category.

Application

- Planned EL/PL should normally be requested at least 7 calendar days in advance.
- CL may generally be requested on shorter notice.
- Emergency leave should be reported as soon as practicable.
- Approval should be obtained before taking planned leave.

Carry Forward

Earned/Privilege Leave may be carried forward subject to the applicable statutory ceiling and company rules. Illustratively, up to 30 days may be carried forward where lawful. CL and SL normally lapse at year-end unless law or a specific policy provides otherwise.

Encashment

Leave encashment, if offered, will be administered according to applicable law, company policy and the employee's applicable terms.

Unauthorised Absence

Absence without approval or adequate explanation may be treated as unauthorised absence and may result in loss of pay or disciplinary action, subject to due process.

10. Compensation, Payroll & Deductions

Payroll

Salary is normally processed monthly and credited to the employee's registered bank account. Payroll dates may be adjusted for bank holidays or operational reasons.

Salary Components

Compensation may include basic salary, allowances, employer contributions, variable pay and other components described in the appointment letter or compensation statement.

Statutory Deductions

- Provident Fund and related contributions where applicable.
- Professional tax where applicable.
- Income-tax withholding/TDS as required by law.
- Other lawful deductions authorised by the employee or permitted by law.

Payroll Corrections

Employees should raise salary discrepancies with HR/Payroll promptly. The company may recover genuine overpayments through lawful and reasonable processes.

Variable Pay

Bonus/incentive plans, if applicable, are governed by their specific plan terms. Business performance, individual performance, eligibility and employment status may affect payout.

11. Benefits & Reimbursements

Benefit	Illustrative approach
Group medical insurance	Coverage subject to insurer terms and policy schedule
Group personal accident / life cover	If included in the company's insurance programme
Provident Fund	As applicable under EPF law
Gratuity	As applicable under the Payment of Gratuity Act and related law
Meal / communication allowance	Only where included in compensation or policy
Learning budget	Subject to annual allocation and approval
Business expense reimbursement	Reasonable, documented business expenses under travel/expense policy

Insurance

Insurance coverage is governed by the insurer's policy wording, exclusions, limits and eligibility. HR can help employees understand the process but cannot override insurer decisions.

Reimbursement

Claims should normally be submitted within 30 days of the expense with valid receipts and business justification.

12. Performance, Development & Career

Performance Management

Employees and managers should agree clear goals, expected behaviours and measurable outcomes. Performance discussions should occur regularly, not only at year-end.

Performance Cycle

- Goal setting at the beginning of the cycle.
- Regular check-ins and feedback.
- Mid-cycle review where applicable.
- Year-end assessment and development planning.
- Compensation review according to company process and business conditions.

Performance Improvement

Where performance does not meet expectations, the company may provide coaching, additional support and a documented improvement plan. Serious misconduct may be handled separately.

Learning

Employees are encouraged to use approved training, technical learning, mentoring and knowledge-sharing opportunities. Managers should support learning that improves current or future role capability.

13. Code of Conduct

Employees are expected to conduct themselves professionally and lawfully in all company-related activities.

- Be honest in records, communications, expense claims and reporting.
- Treat colleagues, customers, suppliers and visitors respectfully.
- Protect company property, systems and confidential information.
- Avoid behaviour that creates conflicts of interest or reputational risk.
- Do not falsify records, credentials, attendance or business information.
- Do not misuse company resources for unlawful or harmful activities.
- Cooperate with legitimate investigations and preserve relevant information.

Professional Communication

Email, chat, meetings and other workplace communication should be factual, respectful and appropriate for a professional environment. Threats, abusive language, discriminatory remarks and deliberate humiliation are prohibited.

14. Anti-Harassment & POSH

NovaSphere maintains a zero-tolerance approach to sexual harassment and prohibits retaliation against anyone who raises a concern or participates in an investigation.

POSH Framework

The company will maintain an Internal Committee (IC) where required by the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 and applicable rules.

Examples of Prohibited Conduct

- Unwelcome sexual advances or requests for sexual favours.
- Sexually coloured remarks, jokes or messages.
- Unwelcome touching or physical conduct.
- Sharing sexually explicit material in a workplace context.
- Conduct creating a hostile, intimidating or offensive environment.

Reporting

Complaints may be made through the channels communicated by the IC/HR. Confidentiality will be maintained to the extent required by law and process. Knowingly false complaints may be addressed under applicable law, but a complaint will not be treated as false merely because it is not substantiated.

Retaliation

Retaliation against a complainant, respondent, witness or participant is prohibited.

15. Equal Opportunity, Diversity & Inclusion

The company seeks a workplace where employment decisions are made fairly and where employees can work without discrimination or harassment.

Fair Employment

Recruitment, assignment, promotion, training, compensation and separation decisions should be based on legitimate job-related criteria and applicable law.

Accessibility & Accommodation

Employees who need workplace accommodation should contact HR. The company will evaluate reasonable accommodations consistent with applicable law, safety and business feasibility.

Respectful Workplace

Employees should avoid stereotypes, exclusionary behaviour, offensive jokes and conduct that undermines colleagues because of protected or personal characteristics.

16. Workplace Health, Safety & Security

Safety Responsibilities

- Follow workplace safety instructions and emergency procedures.
- Report hazards, accidents, injuries and unsafe conditions promptly.
- Do not bypass security or safety controls.
- Use equipment according to training and manufacturer/company guidance.

Emergency Response

Employees should follow building evacuation instructions, emergency alarms and directions from designated safety personnel. The company may conduct drills.

Alcohol, Drugs & Fitness for Work

Employees must not report to work impaired by alcohol or illegal drugs or possess illegal drugs on company premises. Legitimate prescription medication should be managed responsibly so that work is performed safely.

Visitors & Access

Visitors should be authorised and escorted where required. Employees must not share access cards, passwords or security credentials.

17. Information Security & Acceptable Use

Account Security

- Use unique passwords and approved authentication methods.
- Never share passwords, OTPs, tokens or private keys.
- Report suspected compromise immediately.
- Lock devices when unattended.

Company Systems

Company devices, networks, applications and accounts are primarily for business use. Limited personal use may be allowed if lawful, secure, reasonable and not disruptive.

Prohibited Activities

- Unauthorised access, credential sharing or bypassing security controls.
- Installing unapproved software or malicious code.
- Using company systems for fraud, harassment or unlawful activities.
- Uploading confidential company/customer data to unauthorised public AI or third-party services.
- Circumventing data-loss-prevention or monitoring controls.

AI Tools

Employees may use approved AI tools for legitimate work, subject to data classification, customer obligations, intellectual property requirements and security controls. Confidential, personal or restricted information must not be entered into unapproved AI services.

18. Privacy & Employee Data

The company collects and uses employee information for legitimate employment, payroll, benefits, security, compliance and business purposes.

Data Principles

- Collect information for defined legitimate purposes.
- Limit access to authorised personnel.
- Keep records accurate and update them when necessary.
- Retain information only as required for legitimate purposes and applicable law.
- Use appropriate technical and organisational safeguards.

Employee Responsibilities

Employees should provide accurate information, protect other people's personal data and report suspected privacy incidents promptly.

Monitoring

Company systems may be monitored for security, compliance, operational and legitimate business purposes, subject to applicable law and company notices.

19. Intellectual Property & Confidentiality

Confidential Information

Confidential information includes non-public customer information, source code, architecture, credentials, pricing, business plans, financial information, employee data and other information designated or reasonably understood as confidential.

Employee Duties

- Use confidential information only for authorised work.
- Do not disclose it to unauthorised people.
- Store it only in approved systems.
- Return or securely delete company information when required.
- Continue confidentiality obligations after employment where applicable.

Intellectual Property

Work product created in the course of employment may belong to the company to the extent provided by applicable law and the employment agreement. Employees must comply with third-party licence and open-source obligations.

20. Conflict of Interest & Gifts

Conflicts

Employees should avoid situations where personal interests could improperly influence business decisions. Potential conflicts should be disclosed to the manager and HR/Compliance.

Examples

- Personal financial interest in a supplier being evaluated by the employee.
- Hiring, supervising or influencing decisions involving a close relative without disclosure.
- Outside work that competes with the company or interferes with duties.
- Using company opportunities, information or property for personal gain.

Gifts & Hospitality

Employees must not accept or offer gifts, hospitality or benefits that could influence, or reasonably appear to influence, a business decision. Cash or cash equivalents must not be accepted. Modest customary hospitality may be permitted subject to company limits and customer/vendor rules.

21. Travel & Business Expenses

Business Travel

Travel must be business-related, reasonable and approved according to the applicable travel process. Employees should use preferred suppliers where available.

Expense	Illustrative rule
Air travel	Economy for routine domestic travel; higher classes only where policy/approval permits
Hotel	Reasonable business hotel within the approved city limit
Local transport	Actual reasonable business expense with supporting proof where required
Meals	Actual reasonable expense within policy limits
Personal expenses	Not reimbursable unless explicitly approved
Client entertainment	Requires legitimate business purpose and appropriate approval

Expense Claims

Claims should include date, purpose, amount and receipts where required. False or inflated claims may result in disciplinary action.

22. Attendance, Misconduct & Disciplinary Process

Examples of Misconduct

- Fraud, theft or falsification.
- Serious insubordination or workplace violence.
- Harassment or discrimination.
- Unauthorised disclosure of confidential information.
- Repeated unauthorised absence.
- Serious information-security violations.
- Misuse of company property or funds.

Fair Process

Where disciplinary action is considered, the company will follow applicable law, employment terms and principles of procedural fairness. Depending on the circumstances, the process may include fact finding, written notice, opportunity to respond, review of evidence and a decision by the authorised manager/HR.

Possible Outcomes

Outcomes may include coaching, warning, performance action, suspension where lawful, recovery of losses where lawful, or termination/separation in accordance with applicable law and contract.

No Retaliation

Employees should be able to raise good-faith concerns without retaliation.

23. Grievances & Whistleblowing

Grievance Process

Employees should normally raise workplace concerns with their manager or HR. If the concern involves the manager, the employee may approach HR or another designated escalation channel.

Whistleblowing

Good-faith reporting of suspected fraud, corruption, serious legal violations, financial misconduct or major policy breaches is encouraged. Reports will be handled confidentially to the extent practicable.

Investigation

The company may appoint an investigator or review panel. Employees are expected to cooperate, preserve relevant records and avoid discussing confidential investigation details unnecessarily.

Protection

Retaliation against a person who makes a good-faith report or participates in an investigation is prohibited.

24. Separation, Notice & Final Settlement

Resignation

Employees should resign in writing through the designated HR process. The notice period is the period stated in the appointment letter, subject to applicable law.

Notice Period

Employees are expected to perform duties normally during notice unless otherwise agreed. The company may approve early release, notice adjustment or other arrangements where permitted.

Company-Initiated Separation

Termination for performance, misconduct, redundancy or other lawful reasons will be handled according to the employment agreement and applicable law.

Final Settlement

Final settlement may include unpaid salary, eligible reimbursements, statutory dues, eligible leave encashment and other contractual amounts, less lawful deductions and recoveries.

Exit Responsibilities

- Return company equipment, cards, documents and other property.
- Transfer work and knowledge as requested.
- Remove company data from personal systems where instructed and lawful.
- Maintain confidentiality after departure.

25. Policy Governance & Employee Acknowledgement

Policy Changes

The company may update this handbook to reflect legal changes, business needs, benefit changes or operational improvements. Material changes will be communicated through appropriate channels.

Local Addenda

Where state-specific or establishment-specific requirements apply, HR may issue a local addendum. The applicable statutory requirement will prevail over a conflicting generic provision.

Questions

Employees should contact People & Culture for interpretation, leave administration, benefits, payroll, grievances and policy questions.

Employee Acknowledgement

I acknowledge that I have received access to the NovaSphere Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Employee Handbook. I understand that I am responsible for reading and following applicable company policies, procedures and lawful instructions. I understand that this handbook is a policy guide and does not replace my appointment letter or applicable law.

Employee name	_____
Employee ID	_____
Signature	_____
Date	_____

Appendix A — Quick Leave Guide

Need	What to do	Typical notice
Planned vacation	Apply EL/PL in HR system and obtain approval	7+ days
Short personal need	Apply CL where available	As early as possible
Illness	Notify manager and submit leave request	Before shift where practicable
Hospitalisation	Notify HR/manager; provide required documentation	As soon as practicable
Birth/adoption	Contact HR early for statutory/company benefits	Preferably before leave starts
Bereavement	Notify manager/HR and select bereavement leave	As soon as practicable
Extended unpaid leave	Submit written request with dates and reason	Advance approval required

Manager Checklist

- Check leave balance and applicable leave category.
- Confirm business coverage without unreasonably obstructing statutory leave.
- Record approval/rejection in the official system.
- Escalate unusual or legally sensitive cases to HR.

Appendix B — Key Indian Employment Laws & References

The following are commonly relevant to an Indian private-sector employee handbook. Applicability depends on the establishment, employee category, state and facts; HR/legal should verify the current position before adoption.

- The Maternity Benefit Act, 1961, as amended — maternity benefits and related protections.
- The Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 — workplace sexual-harassment prevention and complaint mechanism.
- The Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952 — provident fund and related statutory benefits where applicable.
- The Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972 — gratuity eligibility and payment where applicable.
- The Payment of Wages Act, 1936 and applicable wage laws — wage payment/deduction principles, as relevant under the prevailing legal framework.
- The Code on Wages, 2019 and other labour-code developments — implementation status and applicable rules should be checked before policy adoption.
- Applicable state Shops and Establishments legislation — working hours, leave, holidays and other establishment-level requirements.
- Applicable disability, parental, occupational safety, privacy and employment laws/regulations, as relevant to the business and workforce.

Final Note

This 30-page handbook is intentionally written with a fictional employer and illustrative benefits. Replace the dummy company identity, statutory registrations, addresses, contacts, insurance details, holiday calendar, leave numbers and state-specific rules after legal/HR review. Do not publish it as a final company policy without that review.